

doing any highly-intensive task on your phone. In day-to-day usage, the phone feels just as smooth as its Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 counterpart. However, fire up a game or two of BGMI and after half an hour or so, you will feel the drop in frame rate. Additionally, after this strenuous session of gaming, the phone continued lagging for 5-10 minutes even when doing basic tasks such as scrolling through the screens or messaging on WhatsApp.

This is where the flagship experience gets away from the Samsung Galaxy S24. It will be interesting to see how this device fares long-term compared to the S24 Ultra with the Snapdragon 8 Gen 3. So, overall, the Samsung Galaxy S24 is a powerful phone, but it faces the same issue as the Pixel 8 Pro – the chipset is not a complete flagship. As for software, it is Samsung's most refined yet – everything is super clean and polished, animations are the best I've experienced on a Samsung device so far, and with Good Lock, there's no stopping how much you can customise this phone to your liking. The best part is that Samsung is now providing a MASSIVE seven years of OS and security updates, which is excellent.

## **GALAXY AI**

The Galaxy Unpacked event was all about Galaxy AI – a slew of AI-assisted features present on the Galaxy S24 family of smartphones that attempt to make life easier. While some of these features may still seem more like party tricks than practical aids, there are several standout functionalities that left a lasting impression.

Among these, Circle to Search stands out as a personal favourite. This feature allows users to initiate a Google Search simply by circling the desired item or subject, providing swift access to relevant information.

Chat Assist is another noteworthy addition, offering users the ability to translate text into different languages, correct spelling and grammar errors, and even adjust the tone of the message. While Live Translate during calls appears promising, real-world performance was quite inconsistent, with occasional inaccuracies in translation.

Samsung's take on generative AI editing, akin to the Pixel 8 Pro's capabilities, introduces functionalities such as object manipulation, resizing, and removal. Processing times are lengthy, sure, but the results are generally pretty good, although there are some occasional glitches. So, Galaxy AI, while not perfect, is certainly a right step towards our AI-assisted future. I already can't wait to check this feature out as the technology gets more robust.

## **CAMERAS**

The Samsung Galaxy S24 packs the same set of cameras as its predecessor. The photos from the primary camera in daylight come out pretty great; Samsung gets the white balance right as well. The photos can be quite contrast-heavy at times, but it looks great for social media. Photos from the 3x telephoto shooter in daylight have similar colour science and look plenty detailed for the most part. The 12 MP ultrawide camera is also capable of clicking some fantastic images in daylight. Colours also look more natural than they did on the S23 – so the tuning has improved a bit.

As for portraits, both 1x and 3x portrait shots look great in ideal lighting. However, I did notice that the 3x portrait shots against harsh light come out a bit soft and blurry. Additionally, the highlights aren't as controlled as one would hope for. In low-light, the disparity between the 1x and 3x portrait shots is more pronounced – detail retention is just not as good on the 3x camera.

As for low-light shots in general, they look pretty decent. The detail retention and colour look good, but there is some level of grain prevalent. Additionally, in extreme low light, the S24 tends to boost the exposure up a lot which just doesn't look flattering. Lens flare is also a bit of an issue. Overall, these are powerful cameras – some of the best at this price even now, but they are in serious need of an upgrade since phones such as the OnePlus 12 and iQOO 12 are doing such great things with their cameras at a lower price.

## **BATTERY LIFE**

The Samsung Galaxy S24 surprised us with its excellent battery life. I was constantly ending days with at least 20-30 per cent battery left which is exceptional for a phone this size. In our 4K video loop test, the Samsung Galaxy S24 lasted almost a whopping 17 hours! The only disappointment is the charging speed. The S24 takes 1 hour and 14 minutes to charge to full. You do get wireless charging and reverse wireless charging support, as usual.

## **VERDICT**

The Samsung Galaxy S24 offers incremental upgrades from its predecessor – the Galaxy S23 – without revolutionary changes. The brighter, larger display and Armor Aluminum 2 frame with a matte finish are notable improvements. One UI 6.1 enhances functionality, alongside the Galaxy AI features. Seven years of software support is a strong selling point as well. The Exynos 2400 chipset, while closer to the Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 in performance than ever before, faces throttling and heat management challenges.

The S24 remains a compact flagship, appealing to those seeking a smaller device and Samsung's latest technology. However, for those seeking alternatives or dissatisfied with Exynos, exploring other options might be wise until pricing stabilises. The Galaxy S23 could actually offer better value until then. Not to forget some worthy contenders such as the OnePlus 12, iQOO 12, and Pixel 8 as well.

–Dhriti Datta

## **SPECIFICATIONS**

Processor: Exynos 2400 (4 nm) | CPU: 10-core  
| GPU: Xclipse 940 | RAM: 8/12 GB LPDDR5X  
| ROM: 256/512 GB UFS 4.0 | Display: 6.2"  
Dynamic LTPO AMOLED 2X, Full HD+ (1080 x 2340 pixels) | Display refresh rate: 120 Hz  
Adaptive | Display protection: Corning Gorilla Glass Victus 2 | Cameras (rear): 50 MP + 10 MP + 12 MP; 8K at 30 fps video recording | Camera (selfie): 12 MP, 4K at 60 fps video recording | Battery capacity: 4,000 mAh | Charging: 25 W (wired), 15 W (wireless), 4.5 W (reverse wireless) | IP rating: IP68

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